



Fat

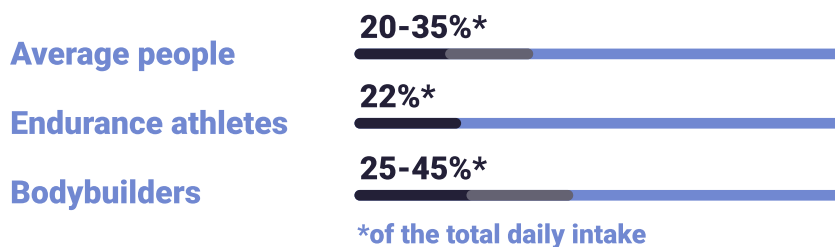
Definition:

Your body will produce its own fat from consuming excess calories. For macronutrients we refer to a different kind of fat which we consume through the food we eat. This is called dietary fat.

Key functions:

Dietary fat is important because it helps us to maintain a healthy immune function. It also helps us to absorb certain vitamins, produce recovery hormones and is an energy store to tap into particularly during low intensity and long duration exercise.

Guidance daily range:



Good sources:

Red meat, oily fish, olives, eggs, cheese, nuts & seeds, avocado, olive oil, full fat dairy and coconut oil.

***N.B.** It is not dietary fat that makes people fat. Eating in a calorie surplus (i.e. more calorie than they burn) is what causes excess weight and fat mass.

Protein, fat and carbohydrate all have different effects on the body but you could eat high amounts of fat for example and still maintain your current weight as long as you're not eating excess calories.

Protein

Definition:

Protein is an essential nutrient for the human body, it's a building block for tissue and muscle and can also serve as a fuel source.

Key functions:

Protein has a key function to grow and repair body cells. It is also important for healthy hair and skin, immune function, weight loss and healthy ageing.





Guidance daily range:

Average people	0.8-1.2g*
Endurance athletes	1.2-1.7g*
Bodybuilders	1.8-2.7g*

*per kg of body weight

Good sources:

Lean beef, chicken, white fish (cod, tuna or sea bream e.g.), milk, yoghurt, cheese, eggs, tofu, nuts, Greek yogurt, lentils, chickpeas, black beans, cottage cheese, hemp seeds, chia seeds, edamame green peas, quinoa and peanut butter.

Carbohydrate

Definition:

Carbohydrates have an important function to provide your body with energy. They are an important source of fuel for activities we do during our days e.g. filing, lifting, sweeping and gardening. From a performance standpoint in sports they are really important in the movements of a sport e.g. take soccer where you need fuel to kick, jump, side shuffle etc.

Key functions:

Acts as the main source of energy in all living organisms and provide an important source of fuel to the brain and central nervous system.

Guidance daily range:

Average	1-4g*
Weight loss	1-3g*
Muscle gain	2-6g*
Endurance athletes	3-10g*

*per kg of body weight

Good sources:

Vegetables, fruits, whole grains, seeds, nuts and beans.

N.B.: The above sources are also suppliers of a type of carbohydrate called fibre which is important because it promotes bowel regularity, helps to control cholesterol and has an additional benefit of helping us feel full.

